FICTION

21/02/26

Syllabus -

Imp: lessons marked in red are studied in each unit

1. Unit - I

John Bunyan - The pilgrim's progress

Daniel Defoe - The Adventures of Robinson Crusoe

Jonathan Swift - Gulliver's Travels

2. Unit - II

Samuel Richardson - Pamela

Henry Fielding - Joseph Andrews

Oliver Goldsmith - The Vicar of Wakefield

3. Unit - III

Jane Austen - Emma

Sir Walter Scott - Ivanhoe

Charles Dickens - Great Expectations

4 Unit - IV

Joseph Conrad - The heart of darkness

E. M Forster - A passage of India

D. H Lawrence - Sons and Lovers

5. Unit - V

Virginia woolf - Mrs. Dalloway

Graham Greene - The power and the Glory

William Golding - The Lord of the Flies

Unit - 1

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Jonathan Swift - Gulliver's Travels

About the Writer -

Jonathan Swift (1667 - 1745)

Era and Age - Augustan Age / Neo-Classical / Age of Reason / Age of Pope, 17th - 18th Century (1700 - 1750)

Titles - "Prince of Satirists" - literary Critics

Admirers -

1. Admired for powerful satire.
2. Influenced later satirists

Critics -

1. Considered too bitter and harsh
2. Accused of misanthropy

Contribution -

1. Perfected social satire
2. Criticized corruption and human pride
3. Strengthened prose satire tradition

Gulliver's Travels -

is Satirical travel narrative of four Voyages exposing human pride, political corruption and intellectual absurdity.

Each land reflects human weakness through exaggeration.

Themes –

1. Human folly – Selfish and corrupt.
2. Political Satire – Criticism of British politics and war
3. Civilization Vs Savagery – Human behaves worse than animals.

Characters –

Lemuel → Traveller and narrator
→ Observer of human society
Gulliver → Represents changing human perspective

Houyhnhnms → Rational horses
→ Pure reason, logic, benevolence
→ Symbol of reason and ideal society

Yahoos → Savage human like creatures

→ Represent human brutality

Important Summary and Main Satire (All lands) –

	Land	Symbolism	Satire / Attack on Humanity
1.	Liliput	Tiny people	Vanity, pride, petty politics, small wars
2.	Brobdingnag	Giants	Human cruelty, greed, arrogance
3.	Laputa	Floating Island of Mad Scientists	Obsession with useless knowledge, impracticality
4.	Houyhnhnms	Wise horses	Rationality Vs human immorality, base instincts
5.	Yahoos	Savage humans	Lust, Greed, violence, corruption, irrationality

Important Quotes –

1. "I cannot but conclude the bulk of your natives to be most pernicious race of little odious vermin." - King of Brobdingnag (on human)

2. "I began to view myself as a Yahoo."
Lemuel gulliver narrating about humans (himself) after travelling to land of houyhnhnms

3. "A wise man should should be cautious of saying what he thinks."

Struldbrugs (immortal beings)

Unit - 2

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Samuel Richardson - Pamela

About the writer -

Samuel Richardson (1689 - 1761)

Era and Age - Augustan Age / 18th Century (1700 - 1750)

Titles - "Father of English domestic novels." - Critics

Admirers - Psychological depth

Critics - Excessive Sentimentality, lengthy narratives

Contribution -

1. Developed epistolary (letter) novel.
2. Introduced psychological realism
3. Focused on middle class morality.

Pamela -

Pamela is written in letter format. Pamela, a young servant girl, resists her master Mr. B improper advances. Despite pressure and emotional manipulation, she protects her virtue.

Eventually, Mr B reforms and marries her. The novel ends with virtue rewarded.

Themes -

1. Virtue rewarded - Morality brings social upliftment.

2. Class and Social Mobility - A servant rises in status.

3. Female integrity - Strength of moral character.

Characters -

Pamela → Virtuous, Modest, Chastity
→ Strong-willed heroine
Andrews → Moral Integrity, Devout
→ Intelligent and observant
→ Resilient and Courageous
→ Polite and respectful

Mr. B → Wealthy and powerful
→ persistent / obsessive
(Lord of the Manor) → Manipulative but reflective
→ later reforms

Important Quotes -

1. "I will die a thousand deaths rather than be dishonest." - Shows Pamela moral strength

Unit - 3

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Sir Walter Scott - Ivanhoe

About the writer -

Sir Walter Scott (1771 - 1832)

Age and Era - Romantic age, late 18th - Early 19th Century (1798-1832)

Titles - "Father of Historical novel" - Critics

Admirers -

1. Influenced european novelists
2. Popular worldwide

Critics - Style considered lengthy and descriptive

Contribution -

1. Popularized historical fiction.
2. Combine romance with history.
3. Revived interest in Scottish Culture

Ivanhoe -

Set in Medieval england, the story follows Ivanhoe, a loyal knight of King Richard. The novel shows Conflict between Saxons and Normans.

Rebecca, a noble Jewish woman, stands out for courage and morality. Themes of chivalry and romance dominate the narrative.

Themes – Chivalry and honor, National Unity, Religious conflict

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Characters –

Wilfred → Protagonist, a Saxon knight
of Ivanhoe → Courageous, loyal, chivalrous, honorable; fights for love and justice
→ Reconciliation between Saxons and Normans

King Richard-I (The Lionheart) → King of England, returning from the crusades
→ Brave, noble, adventurous
→ Often travels disguised as Black Knight

Lady Rowena → Ivanhoe love-interest
→ Beautiful, virtuous, loyal

Rebecca → Jewish healer, Independent, Intelligent
→ Compassionate, self-controlled
→ Morally strong and bold

Brian de Bois-Guilbert → Knight Templar Antagonist
→ Skilled fighter, Morally complex
→ Proud but ultimately torn by forbidden love for Rebecca
→ Serves as dark contrast to Ivanhoe honor

Important Quotes –

1. "Chivalry lives by honor." – Ivanhoe

2. "Faith gives strength." – Rebecca

Unit-4

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D.H Lawrence - Sons and Lovers

About the Writer -

David Herbert Lawrence (D.H. Lawrence)
(1885 - 1930)

25/02 Era & Age - Modern age, Early 20th century (1890 - 1950)

Titles -

"Psychological Novelist of Passion."
- Critics

Admirers - Psychological insight, Influenced moral fiction

Critics - Accused of obscenity, works banned for sexual content.

Contribution -

1. Explored human sexuality openly
2. Focused on human and instinctive life
3. Broke victorian moral restrictions

Sons and Lovers -

Gertrude Morel has an unhappy marriage

to coal miner Walter Morel in the english town of Bestwood. She is devoted to her elder son, William who dies of skin disease.

Mrs. Morel dedicates her life to Paul. Paul has relationships with Miriam and Clara causing conflict between family and romantic love.

Themes - Oedipal conflict, Love Vs Possessiveness

Characters -

Paul Morel
- Sensitive and artistic
- Emotionally dependent on his mother
- Intelligent and thoughtful
- Emotionally conflicted

Gertrude Morel (Mrs. Morel)
- Paul mother, most powerful influence
- Loving but dominating
- Intelligent and refined

Miriam Leivers
- Spiritual and religious
- Emotionally deep
- Sensitive and pure

Clara Dawes
- Physically passionate
- Independent and modern

Important Quotes -

1. "She was the pivot and pole of his life, from which he could not escape."

Narrator about Paul and Mrs Morel

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2. "He could not love her, because his mother held him."

Narrator about Paul and Miriam

Unit -5

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William Golding - The Lord of the Flies

About the Writer -

William Golding (1911 - 1993)

Era and Age - Modern / Postmodern Age, 20th Century (1945 - present)

Titles and Awards -

1. Nobel Prize in literature (1983)
2. Booker prize (1980).

Admirers -

1. praised for Symbolic fiction.
2. Studied widely in Schools
3. Explored Civilization Vs Savagery

Critics - Considered pessimistic, Dark view of human nature

Contribution -

1. Explored evil in human nature.
2. Used Symbolism and allegory
3. Refined post-war English fiction.

The Lord of the Flies –

A group of schoolboys are stranded on the Island. Ralph tries to maintain order, but Jack promotes savagery.

Gradually, civilization collapses. Simon and Piggy die. The boy descend into into chaos before rescue arrives.

Themes –

1. Evil is inside human Nature – Without societal rules, humans naturally become violent and cruel.

2. Loss of innocence – Become violent killers.

Characters –

Ralph
- leader, Protagonist
- Civilization, democracy, order
- Responsible, fair, mature

Jack
- Antagonist, Hunter-leader
- Savagery, power, dictatorship

Morriden
- Cruel, aggressive, power-hungry, violent
- Wild, barbaric

Piggy
- Advisor, Intellectual
- Logic, science, intelligence
- Wise, Rational, physically weak
- Dies, killed by Roger

Simon
- Spiritual, symbolic leader
- Truth, goodness, morality
- Kind, sensitive, insightful
- Dies, killed by boys

Roger
- Jack's executioner
- Pure cruelty, brutality
- Sadistic, violent

Important Quotes –

1. "Maybe there is a beast... maybe it's only us." – Simon

2. "The conch exploded into a thousand white fragments." – Narrator on Piggy death meaning end of civilization.

3. "Ralph wept for the end of innocence." – Narrator, ending